# INTRODUCTION TO SOCIAL SCIENCE

Comprehensive, exam-oriented study notes

Approximately 30–50 pages when printed in standard A4 formatting

Prepared as a structured study guide covering concepts, theories, institutions, research methods, contemporary issues and likely examination areas.

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# 1. Meaning, Nature and Scope of Social Science

Social science is the systematic study of human beings, their relationships, institutions, behaviour and social environments. It examines how individuals and groups interact and how social structures influence opportunities, beliefs and actions.

Social science differs from the natural sciences mainly in subject matter, although both seek systematic knowledge. Because human beings interpret their circumstances and can change their behaviour, social research must take account of meaning, culture, history and context.

Major branches include sociology, political science, economics, anthropology, psychology, human geography, history, communication studies and related interdisciplinary fields. Their boundaries overlap, and contemporary problems are often studied using several disciplines together.

## Key characteristics

• Systematic and evidence-based; concerned with social relationships; sensitive to culture and historical context; uses qualitative and quantitative methods; seeks explanation, interpretation and sometimes prediction; concerned with both individual agency and social structure.

## Importance

• Social science helps governments design policies, organizations understand people, communities address social problems, and citizens evaluate claims about society. It also develops critical thinking, research skills and civic awareness.

## Exam focus

• Define social science. Explain its characteristics. Distinguish social science from natural science. Discuss the major branches and their contributions. Explain why an interdisciplinary approach is useful.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with meaning, nature and scope of social science.
2. Discuss the importance of meaning, nature and scope of social science in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with meaning, nature and scope of social science.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 2. Historical Development of Social Science

The study of society has ancient roots in philosophical reflections on justice, government, morality, family and social order. Thinkers in different civilizations asked questions about how societies should be organized and why people behave collectively.

Modern social science expanded during the Enlightenment and the Industrial Revolution. Rapid urbanization, industrialization, political change and social inequality created new problems that required systematic investigation.

Auguste Comte is commonly associated with positivism and the use of scientific methods to study society. Karl Marx emphasized class conflict and economic structures; Émile Durkheim examined social facts, solidarity and institutions; Max Weber stressed social action, meaning and interpretive understanding.

## Key concepts

• Positivism: the view that reliable knowledge should be grounded in systematic observation and evidence. Social facts: ways of acting and thinking that exist outside individual persons and exert social influence. Social action: behaviour to which actors attach meaning.

## Exam focus

• Trace the development of social science. Discuss the contributions of Comte, Marx, Durkheim and Weber. Explain the effects of industrialization on the development of social inquiry.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with historical development of social science.
2. Discuss the importance of historical development of social science in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with historical development of social science.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 3. Culture and Society

Culture is the learned and shared system of meanings, values, norms, symbols, language, knowledge and practices through which people organize social life. Society refers to a population whose members interact within relatively enduring social relationships and institutions.

Culture is learned rather than biologically inherited. Socialization, education, family, religion, peers and media transmit cultural patterns. Culture can also change through innovation, migration, globalization, technological change and contact between groups.

Important concepts include norms, values, beliefs, symbols, language, material culture and non-material culture. Cultural relativism encourages understanding practices within their cultural context, while ethnocentrism involves judging other cultures mainly by the standards of one's own culture.

## Functions of culture

• Provides identity; guides behaviour; facilitates communication; creates belonging; transmits knowledge; establishes expectations; and helps societies adapt to changing circumstances.

## Kenyan examples

• Languages, food practices, marriage customs, age-based traditions, religious practices, music, dress and community celebrations illustrate cultural diversity. Urbanization and digital media also produce rapidly changing cultural forms.

## Exam focus

• Define culture. Differentiate material and non-material culture. Explain socialization and cultural transmission. Discuss ethnocentrism and cultural relativism.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with culture and society.
2. Discuss the importance of culture and society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with culture and society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 4. Socialization and Social Interaction

Socialization is the lifelong process through which people learn the knowledge, skills, values and behavioural expectations required to participate in society. Primary socialization occurs mainly in childhood, while secondary socialization continues through school, work, peer groups and other institutions.

Agents of socialization include family, school, peers, religion, media, workplace and state institutions. Socialization contributes to personality development and social continuity, but individuals also interpret and sometimes resist expectations.

Social interaction involves reciprocal action between people. Concepts such as status, role, role conflict, role strain and reference groups help explain how individuals navigate social life.

## Status and roles

• A status is a socially recognized position, while a role is the expected behaviour associated with that position. Ascribed status is assigned largely without choice, whereas achieved status is gained through action or circumstances.

## Exam focus

• Explain socialization and its agents. Distinguish status from role. Discuss how social interaction shapes identity.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with socialization and social interaction.
2. Discuss the importance of socialization and social interaction in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with socialization and social interaction.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 5. Social Groups, Communities and Organizations

A social group consists of people who interact and share some sense of membership or common identity. Primary groups are characterized by close, personal relationships; secondary groups tend to be larger, more formal and goal-oriented.

Reference groups provide standards for comparison and evaluation. In-groups are groups with which people identify, while out-groups are perceived as outside one's group. Communities may be based on locality, identity or shared interests.

Formal organizations are structured around explicit goals, rules and roles. Bureaucracy is a form of organization characterized by specialization, hierarchy, written procedures and impersonal rules. Organizations can improve coordination but may also become rigid.

## Exam focus

• Differentiate primary and secondary groups. Explain in-group and out-group. Discuss characteristics, advantages and limitations of bureaucracy.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social groups, communities and organizations.
2. Discuss the importance of social groups, communities and organizations in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social groups, communities and organizations.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 6. Social Institutions

Social institutions are established patterns of social behaviour organized around important societal needs. Major institutions include family, education, religion, economy, government and the legal system.

Institutions socialize individuals, regulate behaviour, allocate resources and provide continuity. Their functions can be intended or unintended, and institutions may produce both benefits and inequalities.

Institutions are interconnected. For example, economic conditions influence education, education affects employment, political decisions shape social services, and family structures interact with economic and cultural change.

## Exam focus

• Define social institution. Discuss the functions of family, education, religion, economy and government. Explain how institutions are interdependent.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social institutions.
2. Discuss the importance of social institutions in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social institutions.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 7. Social Stratification, Inequality and Social Mobility

Social stratification is the structured ranking of people or groups into unequal layers. Inequality may involve income, wealth, education, occupation, political power, gender, age, disability or access to services.

Systems of stratification include slavery, caste and class systems. Social class is often associated with economic resources, occupation, education and life chances. Social mobility refers to movement within a system of stratification; it may be upward, downward, horizontal or intergenerational.

Functionalist approaches may emphasize the organization of roles and rewards, while conflict approaches stress unequal power and control of resources. Contemporary analysis recognizes that multiple forms of inequality can overlap.

## Key terms

• Life chances: opportunities people have to obtain valued goods and services. Absolute poverty concerns severe deprivation, while relative poverty compares living standards within a society. Social exclusion refers to barriers that limit full participation.

## Exam focus

• Define social stratification. Explain causes and consequences of inequality. Discuss social mobility. Compare functionalist and conflict explanations of stratification.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social stratification, inequality and social mobility.
2. Discuss the importance of social stratification, inequality and social mobility in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social stratification, inequality and social mobility.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 8. Social Change and Development

Social change refers to significant transformations in social structures, institutions, relationships or cultural patterns over time. Causes include technology, population change, environmental pressures, economic transformations, political movements, migration and cultural diffusion.

Modernization theories emphasize transitions associated with industrialization and urbanization, while dependency and related critical perspectives focus on unequal relationships between powerful and less powerful economies. Development today is increasingly discussed in terms of human capabilities, sustainability, inclusion and quality of life.

Change can create opportunities as well as disruption. Effective development policies therefore consider local knowledge, institutions, inequality, environmental sustainability and participation.

## Exam focus

• Define social change. Explain major causes. Discuss modernization and dependency perspectives. Examine positive and negative effects of globalization and technological change.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social change and development.
2. Discuss the importance of social change and development in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social change and development.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 9. Social Problems and Social Issues

A social problem is a condition widely viewed as harmful and requiring collective response. Examples include poverty, unemployment, crime, corruption, substance misuse, discrimination, gender-based violence, environmental degradation and unequal access to health or education.

Social problems are not simply individual failures. Social structures, institutions, historical conditions, cultural norms and public policies can influence their distribution and persistence. Sociological imagination connects personal experiences with wider social forces.

Responses may include legislation, public education, economic reforms, social protection, community programs, institutional accountability and prevention strategies. Effective solutions require evidence and evaluation.

## Exam focus

• Define a social problem. Explain how personal troubles can be connected to public issues. Discuss causes and possible solutions to selected social problems.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social problems and social issues.
2. Discuss the importance of social problems and social issues in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social problems and social issues.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 10. Social Research

Social research is the systematic collection and analysis of information about social life. A research process normally involves identifying a problem, reviewing literature, developing questions or hypotheses, selecting a design, sampling, collecting data, analyzing results and communicating findings.

Quantitative research uses numerical data and statistical analysis. Qualitative research explores meanings, experiences and processes through methods such as interviews, focus groups, observation and document analysis. Mixed-methods research combines both approaches.

Sampling may be probability-based or non-probability-based. Reliability concerns consistency, while validity concerns whether a method measures what it is intended to measure.

## Ethics

• Researchers should obtain informed consent where appropriate, protect confidentiality, minimize harm, avoid deception unless ethically justified, report findings honestly and respect participants.

## Exam focus

• Define social research. Explain the research process. Compare qualitative and quantitative approaches. Explain reliability, validity, sampling and research ethics.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social research.
2. Discuss the importance of social research in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social research.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 11. Social Science Research Methods

Common methods include surveys, interviews, observation, experiments, case studies, content analysis, historical research and secondary-data analysis. Each has strengths and limitations.

Surveys can reach many respondents efficiently but may suffer from non-response or poorly designed questions. Interviews provide depth but can be time-consuming. Observation captures behaviour in context but raises questions about researcher influence and access.

Case studies provide detailed understanding of particular cases. Experiments can help investigate causal relationships under controlled conditions, although some social questions cannot ethically or practically be studied experimentally.

## Exam focus

• Describe major research methods. Compare interviews and questionnaires. Explain participant observation. Discuss advantages and limitations of case studies and experiments.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social science research methods.
2. Discuss the importance of social science research methods in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social science research methods.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 12. Social Psychology and Human Behaviour

Social psychology examines how people's thoughts, feelings and actions are influenced by other people and social contexts. Topics include attitudes, conformity, obedience, group behaviour, stereotypes, prejudice, identity and interpersonal relationships.

Human behaviour reflects interactions between biological capacities, individual experiences and social environments. Social expectations can influence behaviour, but people are not passive recipients of culture; they interpret, negotiate and sometimes transform social norms.

Prejudice involves negative attitudes toward groups, while discrimination concerns unequal treatment. Stereotypes are generalized beliefs about groups and can contribute to biased judgments.

## Exam focus

• Define social psychology. Explain conformity, prejudice, stereotypes and discrimination. Discuss the interaction between individual agency and social environment.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social psychology and human behaviour.
2. Discuss the importance of social psychology and human behaviour in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social psychology and human behaviour.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 13. Economics and Society

Economics studies production, distribution and consumption of goods and services and the choices made under conditions of scarcity. Social science examines economic behaviour in its institutional and cultural context.

Markets coordinate many exchanges through prices, but economic outcomes are also shaped by governments, laws, social networks, education, culture and unequal access to resources. Employment, inflation, poverty and inequality have both economic and social dimensions.

Key concepts include scarcity, opportunity cost, supply and demand, labour, productivity, public goods and externalities. Understanding these concepts helps social scientists analyze livelihoods and public policy.

## Exam focus

• Explain scarcity and opportunity cost. Discuss the relationship between economics and society. Explain how unemployment and poverty can be studied as social as well as economic issues.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with economics and society.
2. Discuss the importance of economics and society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with economics and society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 14. Political Science, Power and Governance

Political science studies power, government, political institutions, public policy and political behaviour. Power is the capacity to influence decisions, behaviour or allocation of resources.

Governance involves the processes through which collective decisions are made and implemented. Democracy emphasizes participation, representation, accountability, rule of law and protection of rights. Governance can also involve civil society, communities and non-state organizations.

Citizenship involves rights and responsibilities. Political participation includes voting, public debate, community organizing, petitions, peaceful protest and engagement with institutions.

## Exam focus

• Define power and governance. Explain features of democracy. Discuss citizenship and political participation. Distinguish government from governance.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with political science, power and governance.
2. Discuss the importance of political science, power and governance in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with political science, power and governance.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 15. Anthropology and Human Diversity

Anthropology studies humans and their cultures, societies and development. Cultural anthropology examines beliefs, practices and institutions; physical or biological anthropology studies human evolution and biological variation; archaeology examines material remains; linguistic anthropology studies language in social context.

Anthropological approaches emphasize fieldwork, cultural context and comparison. Ethnography provides detailed accounts of social life and often involves prolonged engagement with communities.

Anthropology helps challenge simplistic assumptions about human behaviour by showing how different societies organize family, economy, religion, authority and identity in diverse ways.

## Exam focus

• Define anthropology. Identify its major branches. Explain ethnography and participant observation. Discuss the importance of cultural context.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with anthropology and human diversity.
2. Discuss the importance of anthropology and human diversity in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with anthropology and human diversity.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 16. Geography, Population and Urbanization

Human geography examines relationships between people and places. Population studies consider size, composition, distribution and change. Demographic processes include fertility, mortality and migration.

Urbanization is the growth of towns and cities and the increasing concentration of population and activities in urban areas. It can create employment, innovation and services but may also produce congestion, housing shortages, inequality and pressure on infrastructure.

Population data are useful for planning schools, hospitals, housing, transport and employment programs. Demographic trends should be interpreted alongside economic, cultural and environmental factors.

## Exam focus

• Define population and urbanization. Explain fertility, mortality and migration. Discuss positive and negative effects of urbanization.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with geography, population and urbanization.
2. Discuss the importance of geography, population and urbanization in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with geography, population and urbanization.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 17. Family, Marriage and Kinship

The family is a social institution involving relationships of care, reproduction, socialization and economic cooperation. Family forms vary across societies and historical periods.

Marriage is a socially recognized relationship whose rules differ by culture and law. Kinship refers to relationships understood through descent, marriage and socially recognized ties. Family structures may be nuclear, extended, single-parent, blended or otherwise organized.

Changes in education, employment, migration, law, technology and gender expectations can transform family relationships. Social scientists study both continuity and change without assuming that one family form is universally superior.

## Exam focus

• Define family, marriage and kinship. Explain functions of the family. Discuss changing family patterns and factors producing change.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with family, marriage and kinship.
2. Discuss the importance of family, marriage and kinship in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with family, marriage and kinship.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 18. Religion and Society

Religion involves systems of beliefs, practices, symbols and institutions concerning sacred meanings and ultimate concerns. Sociologists study religion as a social phenomenon without requiring agreement with any particular theological claim.

Durkheim emphasized social solidarity and collective rituals. Weber examined the relationship between religious ideas and social action. Marx viewed religion partly in relation to inequality, ideology and material conditions.

Religion can promote belonging, moral guidance and social support, while religious differences can also become sources of conflict when linked to political or economic competition.

## Exam focus

• Define religion sociologically. Discuss Durkheim, Marx and Weber on religion. Explain positive and negative social functions of religion.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with religion and society.
2. Discuss the importance of religion and society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with religion and society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 19. Education and Society

Education is a process through which knowledge, skills, values and cultural understandings are transmitted and developed. Formal education is organized through institutions such as schools and universities, while informal learning occurs in families, communities and everyday interaction.

Education can promote literacy, employment, social mobility, citizenship and innovation. At the same time, unequal educational opportunities can reproduce existing inequalities. The hidden curriculum refers to implicit lessons about discipline, authority, competition and social expectations.

Contemporary educational issues include access, quality, digital learning, financing, assessment, skills development and the relationship between education and employment.

## Exam focus

• Explain the functions of education. What is the hidden curriculum? Discuss education as an agent of socialization and as a possible mechanism of social mobility.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with education and society.
2. Discuss the importance of education and society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with education and society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 20. Media, Communication and Technology

Communication is the process through which people create and exchange meanings. Mass media include print, radio, television and digital platforms. Social media have changed the speed, scale and structure of communication.

Media can inform citizens, support education and mobilization, provide entertainment and shape public agendas. Concerns include misinformation, privacy, digital inequality, polarization, commercial influence and unequal access to platforms.

Media literacy involves evaluating sources, identifying persuasive techniques, checking evidence and distinguishing verified information from rumor or manipulated content.

## Exam focus

• Discuss functions of mass media. Explain media influence on society. Identify challenges created by digital technology. Explain the importance of media literacy.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with media, communication and technology.
2. Discuss the importance of media, communication and technology in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with media, communication and technology.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 21. Gender and Society

Gender refers to socially constructed expectations, roles and meanings associated with perceived sex and identity. Social scientists distinguish gender from biological sex while recognizing that bodies, identities and social institutions interact in complex ways.

Gender roles are learned through family, education, media, religion, workplaces and peer groups. Gender inequality may appear in access to education, employment, political representation, income, safety and decision-making.

Gender analysis asks how policies and institutions affect different groups and how social expectations can constrain both women and men. Solutions may involve law, education, economic opportunity, institutional reform and prevention of discrimination and violence.

## Exam focus

• Define gender. Explain gender socialization. Discuss causes and effects of gender inequality. Suggest measures for promoting gender equality.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with gender and society.
2. Discuss the importance of gender and society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with gender and society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 22. Environment and Society

Environmental sociology examines relationships between social systems and the natural environment. Human activities such as industrial production, agriculture, settlement and consumption affect ecosystems, while environmental conditions influence health, livelihoods and migration.

Climate change, pollution, deforestation, water scarcity and biodiversity loss are social as well as environmental issues because risks and responsibilities are distributed unequally.

Sustainable development seeks to balance environmental protection, economic well-being and social inclusion across generations. Community participation and accountable institutions are important in environmental governance.

## Exam focus

• Explain the relationship between society and environment. Discuss social causes and consequences of environmental problems. Define sustainable development.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with environment and society.
2. Discuss the importance of environment and society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with environment and society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 23. Globalization and Contemporary Society

Globalization refers to intensifying cross-border flows of people, goods, capital, information, technology and culture. It connects local communities to wider regional and global systems.

Globalization can expand markets, knowledge exchange, technology and cultural interaction. It can also intensify inequality, economic dependency, cultural tensions and vulnerability to global shocks.

Social scientists study globalization at multiple levels: individual experiences, community change, national institutions and global structures. The local and global should therefore be analyzed together.

## Exam focus

• Define globalization. Explain its advantages and disadvantages. Discuss effects on culture, economy, politics and employment.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with globalization and contemporary society.
2. Discuss the importance of globalization and contemporary society in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with globalization and contemporary society.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 24. Social Science in Kenya and Contemporary Applications

Social science is important for understanding Kenya's social diversity, development challenges, governance and public policy. Researchers may study education, health, youth employment, agriculture, urbanization, gender, governance, inequality, culture and environmental change.

Kenyan social research benefits from attention to regional diversity, rural and urban differences, language, community institutions, historical experiences and changing technology. Evidence can support better policy when research findings are communicated clearly and used responsibly.

Students should connect theories to real social situations without treating examples as universal. A strong examination answer defines the concept, explains it using theory, provides relevant examples and reaches a reasoned conclusion.

## Exam focus

• Explain the importance of social science to Kenya's development. Identify areas where social research can improve public policy. Discuss the responsibilities of a social science student and researcher.

## Revision questions

1. Define and explain the key concepts associated with social science in kenya and contemporary applications.
2. Discuss the importance of social science in kenya and contemporary applications in understanding society.
3. Identify major challenges, debates or limitations associated with social science in kenya and contemporary applications.
4. Give relevant examples and explain how the topic can be applied to contemporary social issues.

# 25. Quick Revision Guide

| Concept | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Social science | Systematic study of human society, relationships, institutions and behaviour. |
| Culture | Learned and shared meanings, values, norms, symbols and practices. |
| Socialization | Lifelong process of learning social expectations and participating in society. |
| Status | Socially recognized position occupied by an individual. |
| Role | Expected behaviour associated with a status. |
| Institution | Established pattern of behaviour organized around important social needs. |
| Stratification | Structured inequality among social categories. |
| Social mobility | Movement within a system of social stratification. |
| Social change | Significant transformation in social structures, institutions or cultural patterns. |
| Social research | Systematic investigation of social questions using evidence. |
| Qualitative research | Research emphasizing meanings, experiences and context. |
| Quantitative research | Research emphasizing numerical measurement and statistical analysis. |
| Power | Capacity to influence decisions, behaviour or resource allocation. |
| Globalization | Intensification of cross-border flows and interconnections. |
| Sustainable development | Development that seeks to meet present needs while protecting future generations' ability to meet theirs. |

## Exam Answer Formula

• Start with a clear definition.

• Explain the concept or theory in organized points.

• Use a relevant example, preferably from the local or contemporary context.

• Compare perspectives where appropriate.

• Conclude by directly answering the question.

# 26. Likely Examination Questions

1. Define social science and explain its major characteristics.
2. Discuss the contributions of Comte, Marx, Durkheim and Weber to social thought.
3. Explain the relationship between culture and society.
4. Discuss the agents and importance of socialization.
5. Differentiate primary and secondary groups.
6. Explain the major social institutions and their functions.
7. Discuss social stratification and social mobility.
8. Explain major causes and consequences of social change.
9. What is a social problem? Explain how social problems can be addressed.
10. Describe the social research process.
11. Compare qualitative and quantitative research.
12. Discuss research ethics.
13. Explain power, governance and political participation.
14. Discuss the relationship between education and social mobility.
15. Explain the influence of media and technology on contemporary society.
16. Discuss gender socialization and gender inequality.
17. Explain globalization and its social consequences.
18. Discuss the relationship between environment and society.
19. Explain why social science is important to Kenya's development.
20. Write an essay showing why an interdisciplinary approach is important in social science.

## End of notes